

Daniel Interviews Jose — Master Question Bank

★ = starred picks for tomorrow's shoot (see Content Shoot Plan below). Pull 5-7 per session — never run out.

The Origin Story

- What were you actually doing the day you decided to build Tractify?
- ★ **What was the exact moment you knew cold calling wasn't the move?**
- Walk me through the first phone call you ever made pitching this — what happened?
- What did contractors say that changed how you thought about the whole business?
- When did you first realize this could be a unicorn?
- What did the business look like in your head before you built it versus what it actually became?
- What's the thing you were most wrong about at the beginning?
- Was there a moment you almost quit?

The Product Decisions

- Why SMS? Why not an app, why not a dashboard, why text messages?
- Walk me through why you made the HVAC form just a phone field.
- Why did you build Brain 3 before you had a single paying client?
- Why did you kill the onboarding call before you ever had an onboarding call?
- What made you decide to put the AI in the back end instead of making it the marketing angle?
- Why does the contractor stay on a Tractify subdomain permanently instead of getting their own domain?
- What's the feature you almost built that you're glad you didn't?
- ★ **Why did you decide to charge per appointment instead of a monthly retainer?**

The Pricing Philosophy

- Walk me through how you landed on \$75 per appointment.
- ★ **Why do you charge on the day of the appointment and not when it books?**
- What made you decide to do 5 free jobs instead of a free trial period?
- Why is the setup fee \$2,000?
- What's your honest answer when a contractor says that's too expensive?
- What happens to a contractor who wants to stop?

The Competitive Thinking

- ★ **What does ServiceTitan get wrong about HVAC contractors?**
- What does GoHighLevel get wrong?
- Why do marketing agencies keep failing contractors?
- What does Tractify do that none of them can copy?
- What would you do if a well-funded competitor tried to build exactly what you built?
- What's the moat that compounds automatically without you doing anything?

- If you had to pick the one thing that makes Tractify genuinely different, what is it?

The Contractor Psychology

- Describe the HVAC contractor Tractify is built for.
- What does a day in the life of that contractor actually look like?
- What keeps him up at night that he'd never say out loud?
- Why do contractors keep paying marketing agencies that don't deliver?
- Why does the most experienced contractor sometimes have the worst web presence?
- What did you learn about contractor trust from cold calling?
- ★ **Why does a contractor who misses 8 calls a day not realize he's losing \$56,000 a year?**
- What's the fastest way to lose a contractor's trust?
- What's the fastest way to earn it?

The Homeowner Psychology

- What does a homeowner actually want when their AC breaks?
- Why does a homeowner call three contractors and hire whoever responds first?
- Why does the diagnostic offer work better than "book now"?
- What happens emotionally when Brain 3 responds at 11pm and actually helps them?
- Why does a homeowner who texts a number and gets a real answer become a loyal customer?

The Business Model

- What does Tractify look like at 50 contractors?
- What does it look like at 500?
- What's the thing that makes this defensible long term?
- How does Tractify get smarter automatically the longer a contractor stays?
- What would you say to someone who thinks this is just a website company?
- What's the version of Tractify that beats ServiceTitan's entire market cap?
- Why is HVAC the right place to start?
- What's the second niche and when do you go there?

The Strategy

- Why ads instead of sales?
- Why subdomains forever instead of custom domains?
- Walk me through how 10 channels activate from one contractor signing up.
- What's the diagnostic ad and why does it change everything?
- Why does a missed call become your best asset instead of your biggest problem?
- Why does the billing policy make the product easier to sell?
- What does "contractor logs in once and everything else is a text message" actually mean in practice?
- Why did you decide the machine has to work without Jose or Daniel being involved?

The Build Process

- What was the hardest thing to build technically?
- Walk me through the Twilio compliance situation — what actually happened?
- What's the thing that looked impossible that you figured out anyway?
- What broke that you weren't expecting to break?
- What's Brain 3 and what does it actually do?
- What does a Brain 3 conversation look like start to finish?
- How does Tractify know which channel a booking came from?

The August Bet

★ What's actually at stake in August for you personally?

- What happens if the machine doesn't deliver the 5 jobs?
- What happens if it does?
- What does winning August look like to you?
- What does losing August look like?
- Why are you and Daniel both all-in on this right now?
- What would you tell a contractor who's skeptical this is real?

The Personal Stuff

- What do you actually know about HVAC?
- What does your family think you're doing?
- What's the hardest part of building a company with a co-founder?
- ★ **What's the thing about building that you're genuinely good at?**
- What's the thing you had to build a system around because it doesn't come naturally?
- What does success look like to you in 3 years?
- What do you want this to be before you ever think about selling it?
- What would the version of you from 2 years ago think about what you're building right now?
- What do you know now that you wish you knew at the start?

The Hot Takes

- Is AI in home services overhyped?
- Is the monthly retainer model dead?
- What's the worst piece of business advice you ever got?
- What's something the whole marketing industry gets wrong?
- What would you tell an HVAC contractor who says he doesn't need tech?
- What's wrong with how most people think about free trials?
- Is cold calling dead?
- What do you think about "build it and they will come"?

- What's the most dangerous thing a contractor can do with their marketing budget?

The Forward-Looking Ones

- What does Tractify look like the day you walk away from it?
- If a massive company tried to acquire Tractify in 3 years, what number makes you take the meeting?
- What niche after HVAC and why?
- What does the AI do in year 3 that it can't do today?
- If you had to bet everything on one thing Tractify does that no competitor will ever replicate, what is it?